

FREE GUIDE

The 5 Sleep Fixes Blocking Your Rest

Five evening and morning habits that keep you awake, what to change starting tonight, and a 2-minute checklist you can print.

Before you start

You know the routine. Lights off at 11. Still awake at 1. Up at 7, tired again.

Most advice tells you to "relax more." That's hard to do on command. This guide works the other way: it changes the conditions around your sleep, so your body has an easier time doing what it already knows how to do.

Each fix takes one page. Each one ends with a single thing to try. You don't need to do all five at once. Pick the one that sounds most like you, try it for a week, then add the next.

What's inside

- **Fix 1.** Your wake-up time keeps moving
- **Fix 2.** Your caffeine is still working at midnight
- **Fix 3.** Your evening light says "daytime"
- **Fix 4.** You fight it when you can't sleep
- **Fix 5.** Your bedroom runs warm
- The 2-minute evening checklist

A quick note

This guide shares general sleep habits. It is not medical advice. If you have trouble sleeping three or more nights a week for over three months, if you snore loudly or stop breathing in your sleep, or if you feel sleepy while driving, talk to a doctor. Those can be signs of a sleep disorder that habits alone won't fix.

1

Your wake-up time keeps moving

> *Monday you're up at 6:30. Saturday you sleep until 10 to "catch up." Sunday night, 11 PM comes and you're wide awake.*

Your body runs on an internal clock. The strongest signal that sets it each day is the time you get up and see daylight. When that time jumps by two or three hours on weekends, your clock shifts too. Sunday night your body thinks it's earlier than it is.

Bedtime is hard to control. You can't force sleep. Wake-up time is easier: an alarm does the work.

Why it matters

A steady wake-up time builds steady sleep pressure through the day. By evening you feel tired at a predictable hour, which makes bedtime easier without trying harder.

TRY THIS WEEK

Pick one wake-up time and keep it seven days in a row, weekends included. Stay within 30 minutes of it. Get outside or near a bright window within the first hour.

2

Your caffeine is still working at midnight

> *The 3 PM coffee felt harmless. You were tired, it helped, and by dinner you didn't feel it anymore.*

Not feeling it doesn't mean it's gone. Caffeine stays in your body for hours after the buzz fades. For many adults, half of an afternoon coffee is still active in the evening. It can make sleep lighter and shorter even when you fall asleep fine.

Where it hides

- Coffee and espresso drinks
- Black and green tea, iced tea
- Energy drinks and many sodas
- Pre-workout powders
- Dark chocolate, in smaller amounts

TRY THIS WEEK

Count back 8 hours from your bedtime. If you sleep at 11 PM, your last caffeine is at 3 PM. Switch the afternoon cup to decaf or herbal tea and watch your nights for one week.

3

Your evening light says "daytime"

> *10:30 PM. Overhead lights on, TV on, phone in hand. You put it down at 11 and wonder why your mind is still running.*

Light tells your brain what time it is. Bright light in the evening, especially from overhead lights and screens close to your face, pushes your internal clock later. Your body delays the signal that it's time to sleep.

You don't need to sit in the dark. You need the last hour before bed to look more like evening than noon.

Simple swaps

- Turn off overhead lights after dinner. Use one or two lamps.
- Use night mode on your phone and turn brightness down.
- Charge your phone outside the bedroom, or across the room.
- Swap the last 30 minutes of scrolling for a paper book or a shower.

TRY THIS WEEK

Set a "lights low" alarm one hour before bed. When it rings, overhead lights go off and the phone goes on the charger.

4

You fight it when you can't sleep

> *You've been awake for 40 minutes. You check the clock. You do the math: "If I fall asleep now, I get 5 hours." Now you're more awake.*

Lying in bed awake for a long time teaches your brain that bed is a place for worrying, planning and clock-watching. The harder you try to sleep, the more alert you get.

The 20-minute rule

If you're awake in bed for what feels like about 20 minutes, get up. Go to another room with dim light. Do something calm and boring: fold laundry, read something light, sit and breathe. Go back to bed when you feel sleepy, not before.

It feels wrong the first few nights. Over a week or two, it rebuilds the link between your bed and falling asleep.

TRY THIS WEEK

Turn your clock so you can't see it from bed. If you're awake and frustrated, get up and follow the 20-minute rule. Keep your wake-up time the same the next morning.

5

Your bedroom runs warm

> *You kick the blanket off at 2 AM, then pull it back at 4. You wake up and the room feels stuffy.*

Your body temperature drops a little as you fall asleep and stays lower through the night. A warm, bright or noisy room works against that.

Check your room

- **Cool.** Many people sleep best somewhere around 60 to 67°F (15 to 19°C). Try a degree or two cooler than now.
- **Dark.** Cover standby lights. Use blackout curtains or an eye mask if streetlights come in.
- **Quiet.** A fan or white-noise app covers sudden sounds like cars or neighbors.
- **For sleep.** Move work, bills and the laptop out of the bed if you can.

TRY THIS WEEK

Lower the thermostat by 2 degrees at bedtime and cover every small light in the room with tape or a cloth.

The 2-minute evening checklist

Print this page and keep it by your bed. Tick what you did tonight.

☐ **8 hrs before**	Last caffeine of the day
☐ **2–3 hrs before**	Finish dinner and heavy snacks
☐ **1 hr before**	Overhead lights off, lamps on, phone on the charger
☐ **30 min before**	Something calm: shower, paper book, stretch
☐ **Bedtime**	Room cool, dark and quiet. Clock turned away
☐ **If awake**	About 20 minutes? Get up, dim light, back when sleepy
☐ **Morning**	Same wake-up time. Daylight within the first hour

What happens next

Over the next few days we'll send you a few short emails: what keeps people up at night, one more thing you can try, and a product we looked at that some readers use alongside these habits. You can unsubscribe from any email with one click.

This guide is for general information only and is not medical advice. Talk to a doctor about ongoing sleep problems or before starting any supplement, especially if you take medication or are pregnant.